14.1 Pilot ladders rigged from ships' side openings without a boarding platform shall not extend above the lowest deck of the opening and shall not be rigged from any other position, including the freeboard deck.

14.2 Pilot ladders used in conjunction with ships' side openings with a boarding platform complying with paragraph 7.3 shall be rigged aft of such platforms and may be rigged from the freeboard deck provided that the ladder and manropes are secured above the p latform in accordance with paragraphs 13.1.5 and 13.1.7.
RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025)
PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS
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15 Associated equipment

15.1 The following associated equipment shall be available and ready for immediate use at the point of access whilst the pilot or other personnel are being transferred:

.1 two manropes complying with the requirements stipulated within section 11 which shall:

SOURCE: MSC.576(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf
.1 two manropes complying with the requirements stipulated within section 11 which shall:

.1 be free from contamination and knots; however, knots used to tie or secure manropes to strong points are acceptable;

.2 when required by pilots or other personnel embarking or disembarking, be rigged and secured in accordance with relevant requirements of these performance standards; and

.3 when rigged, be fixed at the rope end to dedicated strong points on the deck and pass through the ring or eye fitted at the top of the stanchions at the point of access to the deck. When the pilot ladder is rigged from a ship side opening, manropes may be rigged from the deck head, provided that the manropes pass through the ring or the eye at the top of the stanchions at the point of access;

.2 a lifebuoy equipped with a self-igniting light; and

.3 a heaving line free from contamination and having a length which can reach
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SOURCE: MSC.576(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf
.2 a lifebuoy equipped with a self-igniting light; and

.3 a heaving line free from contamination and having a length which can reach the waterline in any seagoing condition of draught or trim.

15.2 When required by section 8 of these performance standards, stanchions and bulwark ladders shall be provided.

PART C INSTALLATION OF PILOT LADDER WINCH REELS

16 Stowage of pilot ladders on winch reels

If a pilot ladder is to be stowed on a winch drum, the drum diameter shall be not less than 0.16 m and the drum shall be provided with sunken securing points.

17 Point of access

17.1 When a pilot ladder winch reel is provided, it shall be situated at a position which will ensure pilots and other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot ladder and the point of access to the ship, have safe, convenient and unobstructed access to or egress from the ship.

SOURCE: MSC.576(110).pdf
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pilot ladder and the point of access to the ship, have safe, convenient and unobstructed access to or egress from the ship.

17.2 The point of access position and adjacent area shall be kept clear of obstructions, including the pilot ladder winch reel, for distances as follows:

.1 915 mm in width measured longitudinally;

.2 915 mm in depth, measured from the ship's side plating inwards; and

.3 2,200 mm in height, measured vertically from the access deck.

18 Physical positioning of pilot ladder winch reels

18.1 Pilot ladder winch reels which are fitted on a ship's upper deck for the purpose of providing a pilot ladder which services a ship's side opening below the upper deck or, alternatively, an accommodation ladder when a combination arrangement is provided shall:

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alternatively, an accommodation ladder when a combination arrangement is provided shall:

.1 be situated at a location on the upper deck from which the pilot ladder is able to be suspended vertically, in a straight line, to a point adjacent to the ship's side opening access point or the lower platform of the accommodation ladder;

.2 be situated at a location which provides a safe, convenient and unobstructed passage for pilots or other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot ladder and the place of access on the ship; and

.3 enable compliance with the relevant requirements of part A and part B.

18.2 Pilot ladder winch reels fitted inside a ship's side opening shall:

.1 be situated at a position which provides a safe, convenient and unobstructed passage for pilots or other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot ladder and the place of access on the ship;

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passage for pilots or other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot ladder and the place of access on the ship;

.2 be situated at a position which provides an unobstructed clear area with a minimum length of 915 mm and minimum width of 915 mm and minimum vertical height of 2,200 mm; and

.3 if situated at a position which necessitates a section of the pilot ladder to be partially secured in a horizontal position on the deck so as to provide a clear access as described above, then allowance shall be made so that this section of the pilot ladder may be covered with a rigid platform for a minimum distance of 915 mm measured horizontally from the ship's side inwards.

19 Handrails and handgrips

Handrails and handgrips shall be provided in accordance with section 8 to assist the pilot and other personnel to safely transfer between the pilot ladder and the ship, except as noted in
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SOURCE: MSC.576(110).pdf
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other personnel to safely transfer between the pilot ladder and the ship, except as noted in paragraph 7.4 for arrangements with platforms extending outboard. Th e horizontal distance between the handrails and/or the handgrips shall be not less than 0.7 m or more than 0.8 m apart.

20 Securing of the pilot ladder

Where the pilot ladder is stowed on a pilot ladder winch reel which is located either within the ship's side opening or on the upper deck:

.1 the pilot ladder winch reel shall not be relied upon to support the pilot ladder when the pilot ladder is in use;

.2 the pilot ladder shall be secured to strong points, independent of the pilot ladder winch reel; and

.3 the pilot ladder shall be secured at deck level inside the ship's side opening or, when located on the ship's upper deck, at a distance of not less

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or, when located on the ship's upper deck, at a distance of not less
than 915 mm measured horizontally from the ship's side inwards.

21 Mechanical securing of pilot ladder winch reel

21.1 All pilot ladder winch reels shall have means of preventing the winch reel from being accidentally operated as a result of mechanical failure or human error.

21.2 Pilot ladder winch reels may be manually operated or, alternatively, powered by either electrical, hydraulic or pneumatic means.

21.3 Manually operated pilot ladder winch reels shall be provided with a brake or other suitable arrangements to control the lowering of the pilot ladder and to lock the winch reel in position once the pilot ladder is lowered into position.

21.4 Electrical, hydraulic or pneumatically driven pilot ladder winch reels shall be fitted with safety devices which are capable of cutting off the power supply to the winch reel and thus locking the winch reel in position.

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safety devices which are capable of cutting off the power supply to the winch reel and thus locking the winch reel in position.

21.5 Powered winch reels shall have clearly marked control levers or handles which may be locked in a neutral position.